What makes a choice the best?

Optimization · Level 1 · Lesson 1



Today we will

- Name the options, the limits and the goal of a decision.
- Tell a plan that keeps every limit from the best plan.
- Find the best plan for our class outings, and ask who it leaves out.

Remember

- Options: what you can choose. Limits: what every plan must keep. Goal: what “best” means.
- A feasible plan keeps every limit; the optimal plan is the best of them.
- Quick rules like “favourite first” can miss the best: check them.

The class outings

1. Warm-up (5 min): What makes a day out the best?
2. Teach (8 min): Options, limits and a goal.
3. Vote (5 min): Pupils vote on five outing ideas.
4. Find the best (15 min): Groups find the most votes inside the budget.
5. Wrap-up (7 min): Compare plans; whose favourite was left out?

Prepare one set of five cards per group: the outing, its cost and space to write its votes. No outings planned? Use class rewards instead (a story hour, a football match, a film).

Let’s discuss

1. Why didn’t “favourite first” give the most votes?
2. How do we know a plan is the best, and not just allowed?
3. Whose favourite was left out, and what would be fair next time?

Exit ticket

- Write the options, the limits and the goal of one decision at our school.